Pre-Class Assignment: Yelizarova Essay

"The Missing Institution"

ECON 470 — Microeconomics of Artificial Intelligence

Spring 2026

Reading: Anna Yelizarova, "The Missing Institution: A Global Dividend System for the Age of Transformative AI," *The Digitalist Papers*, Vol. 2 (2024). Available at digitalistpapers.com/vol2/yelizarova.

Due: In person, TBD, at the start of class.

Instructions: Answer each question in 1–3 sentences. These are reading-check questions — they should be quick if you read the essay. You must submit this assignment in person. The assignment must be handwritten. No photocopies will be accepted.

Why we do this: A team of your classmates is presenting this essay and leading a 10-minute discussion afterward. These questions ensure you arrive ready to participate.

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1. Yelizarova argues that national UBI proposals are insufficient for addressing AI-driven displacement. What is her main reason?
2. The essay proposes a global dividend system modeled on existing institutions. Name one of the historical models she draws on and explain in one sentence how it works.
3. Yelizarova discusses two implementation approaches: "pay-as-you-go" and an "endowment model." What is the key advantage of the endowment approach?
4. The essay uses the Russian voucher privatization as a cautionary tale. What went wrong, and what design principle does Yelizarova draw from it?
5. Pick one aspect of Yelizarova's proposal that you found either compelling or unconvincing. State it in one sentence, then say why you reacted the way you did.